

INVENTORY · STACK · STRUCTURE

q-and-a

Anticipated questions paired with prepared answers — the end-of-pitch 'what we expect to be asked' slide.

What the board will press on.

Q Why not extend the current vendor one more year?

A The renewal lands in Q3 and locks us in through 2028. Switching now costs a single quarter of migration; switching after renewal costs three.

Q What happens to the team mid-migration?

A No headcount change. The same four engineers run both stacks through the eight-week overlap, then the legacy stack is decommissioned.

Q How confident are we in the savings?

A The \$1.2M is contracted, not projected — the signed rate differential, before any usage growth.

The one question we know is coming.

Q If the pilot fails, what have we actually lost?

A One quarter and \$180K, fully recoverable. The contract caps exposure at the pilot scope, with no auto-renewal and a thirty-day exit. The downside is bounded; the upside is the whole thesis.

ANTICIPATED QUESTIONS

Five we expect, numbered and tightened.

- 1 Why now rather than next fiscal year?
- 2 The incentive credits expire in December; waiting forfeits \$400K.
- 3 What is the rollback plan?
- 4 A one-command revert to the pinned release, rehearsed weekly in staging.
- 5 Who signs off on go-live?
- 6 The change-advisory board, the Thursday before each wave.
- 7 How does this affect the SLA?
- 8 The 99.9% target holds — the migration runs behind a feature flag.

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When NOT to reach for q-and-a.

A flat FAQ of one-liners. Six or more terse question/answer pairs you flip back to as a reference belong in `faq` or `glossary`, which are built to stack many short look-ups. q-and-a is for a few defended answers, not a help page.

Rhetorical questions with no answer. Every question needs a nested answer that genuinely closes it. A bare question used as a section header or a hook is a `divider` or `statement`, not a Q&A pair.

Evaluation criteria in disguise. If the top-level item is a requirement you are scoring against (with a rationale below), that is `list-criteria`, not a question you expect to be asked. q-and-a defends; list-criteria evaluates.

RELATED COMPONENTS

See also.

`faq` — many terse reference questions to flip back to, not a few weighty defenses

`glossary` — term/definition reference pairs rather than question/answer pairs

`list-criteria` — numbered criteria with rationale — evaluation, not anticipated objections

`cards-stack` — parallel co-equal cards with no question/answer role split

`decision` — a single verdict to state rather than a set of questions to defend